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Eastwards Again: Change of Uniform and Role

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In November, during a brief layover in Delhi during one of the tours, I had gone to the MS Branch to inquire about my next posting since I had been approved for Maj Gen. Nothing had been decided yet, I was told. Moreover, since I was about halfway down the seniority list, my turn would probably take some time coming. I said I was fine with that. Since Veena, who was working abroad, was coming over for the winter break over Christmas and the New Year, my only request was that my posting should only be done in the new year. I felt this was a very unique and doable request. Which sane person asks for his promotion to be deferred? Within the next week itself, however, my orders came to report to my new assignment as Chief of Staff (COS), 33 Corps by 28 December 2012. Bummer.

Apparently, for some archaic reason, the entire June 80 batch of officers who had been approved had to pick up the rank latest by 31 December, if we were to remain eligible for the next increment due on 1 July of the following year. It seems

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